

Single-qubit states and superposition

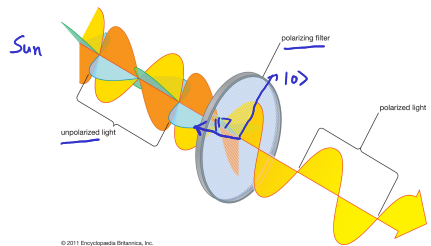
Dr. Arun Sehrawat

video

Simplest quantum system: qubit

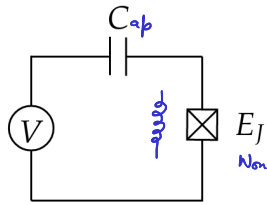
(2 level sys)

$d=2$

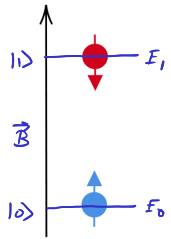


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Polarization = qubit



Superconducting charge qubit

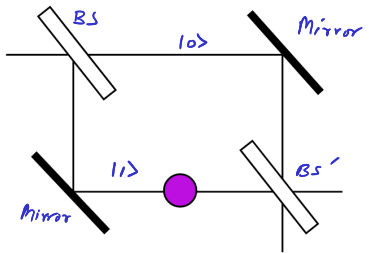


Spin

in mag field

$$E = -\vec{\mu} \cdot \vec{B}$$

Quantum dot

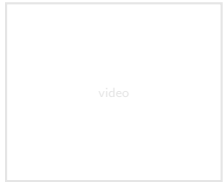


Mach-Zehnder interferometer

Time bin qubit



$$\cos \Phi = 1 - \frac{\phi^2}{2!} + \frac{\phi^4}{4!}$$



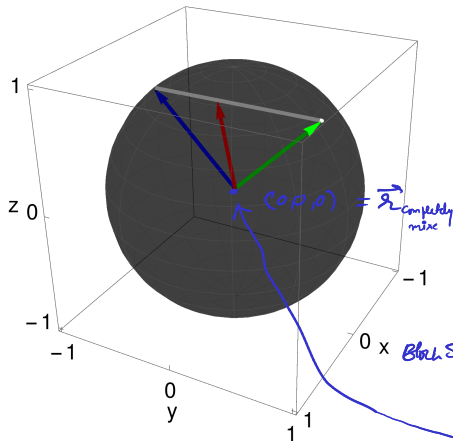
video

Single-qubit "mixed" state

$d=2$

State space is a Convex Set

Convex combination



Bloch Ball

$$\underline{\underline{P = \frac{1}{2}I}}$$

$$\begin{aligned} \rho_{\text{mix}} &= w |\psi\rangle\langle\psi| + (1-w) |\chi\rangle\langle\chi|, \quad 0 < w < 1 \\ &= w \frac{I + \hat{r} \cdot \vec{\sigma}}{2} + (1-w) \frac{I + \hat{s} \cdot \vec{\sigma}}{2} \\ &= \frac{I + \underbrace{(w\hat{r} + (1-w)\hat{s})}_{\vec{r}_{\text{mix}}} \cdot \vec{\sigma}}{2} \end{aligned}$$

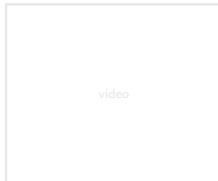
$$|\hat{r}| = |\hat{s}| = 1$$

$$\vec{r}_{\text{mix}} = w\hat{r} + (1-w)\hat{s}, \quad |\vec{r}_{\text{mix}}| < 1$$

Boundary points $\leftrightarrow$ pure states
Interior points $\leftrightarrow$ mixed states

$$P = \frac{I}{2} = \begin{bmatrix} 1/2 & 0 \\ 0 & 1/2 \end{bmatrix}$$

completely mixed state



Single-qubit "pure" state

Pure state vector (ket):

$$|\psi\rangle = \underbrace{[|a_0\rangle\alpha_0 + |a_1\rangle\alpha_1]}_I |\psi\rangle$$

$$|\psi\rangle = |a_0\rangle \underbrace{\langle a_0|\psi\rangle}_{\alpha_0} + |a_1\rangle \underbrace{\langle a_1|\psi\rangle}_{\alpha_1} \equiv \begin{pmatrix} \alpha_0 \\ \alpha_1 \end{pmatrix} \text{ in } \mathcal{B}_a = \{|a_0\rangle, |a_1\rangle\}.$$

$p_i = |\alpha_i|^2$ prob amp

$$C^2 = \mathcal{I}$$

Norm:

- Two complex numbers α_0 and α_1 that obeys $\langle\psi|\psi\rangle = |\alpha_0|^2 + |\alpha_1|^2 = 1$ can be parameterized by three real numbers as

$$\alpha_0 = e^{i\gamma} \cos \frac{\theta}{2}$$

$$\alpha_1 = e^{i\gamma} \sin \frac{\theta}{2} e^{i\phi}$$

$$|\psi\rangle = e^{i\gamma} \left(\cos \frac{\theta}{2} |0\rangle + \sin \frac{\theta}{2} e^{i\phi} |1\rangle \right) = e^{i\gamma} |\psi'\rangle$$

global phase factor

- γ has no observable consequence

$$\langle \Pi \rangle = \langle \psi | \Pi | \psi \rangle = \langle \psi' | \Pi | \psi' \rangle$$

Born Rule

$$\text{Pure quantum state } |\psi\rangle\langle\psi| = |\psi'\rangle\langle\psi'| = \rho$$

$$e^{i\gamma} |\psi'\rangle \langle \psi'| e^{-i\gamma}$$

zx plane $\phi = 0, \pi$

$$|\psi\rangle = \cos \frac{\theta}{2} |0\rangle \pm \sin \frac{\theta}{2} |1\rangle$$

xy plane $\theta = \pi/2$

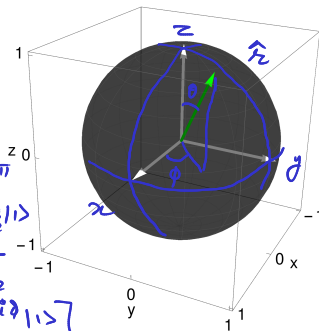
$$|\psi\rangle = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} [|0\rangle + e^{i\phi} |1\rangle]$$

$$\langle \psi' | e^{-i\gamma} \Pi e^{i\gamma} | \psi' \rangle$$

yz plane

$$\phi = \frac{\pi}{2}, \frac{3\pi}{2}$$

$$|\psi\rangle = \cos \frac{\theta}{2} |0\rangle \pm i \sin \frac{\theta}{2} |1\rangle$$



video

Single-qubit "pure" state $S(U(2))$ $| \psi \rangle \in \mathcal{H} \cong \mathbb{C}^2$ $S(O(3))$ $\hat{r} \in \mathbb{R}^3$

$(\theta, \phi) \in \mathbb{R}^2$

$\rho = |\psi\rangle\langle\psi| \equiv \begin{pmatrix} \cos \frac{\theta}{2} \\ \sin \frac{\theta}{2} e^{i\phi} \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} \cos \frac{\theta}{2} & \sin \frac{\theta}{2} e^{-i\phi} \end{pmatrix}$ in $\mathcal{B} = \{|0\rangle, |1\rangle\}$

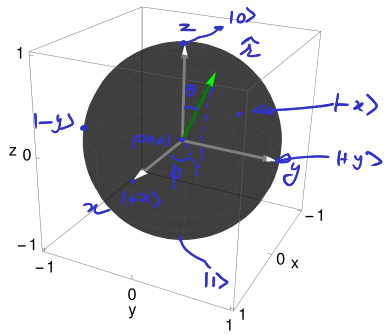
$= \begin{pmatrix} (\cos \frac{\theta}{2})^2 & \cos \frac{\theta}{2} \sin \frac{\theta}{2} e^{-i\phi} \\ \cos \frac{\theta}{2} \sin \frac{\theta}{2} e^{i\phi} & (\sin \frac{\theta}{2})^2 \end{pmatrix}$

$i = \sqrt{-1}$

$= \begin{pmatrix} \frac{1+\cos \theta}{2} & \frac{\sin \theta}{2} e^{-i\phi} \\ \frac{\sin \theta}{2} e^{i\phi} & \frac{1-\cos \theta}{2} \end{pmatrix} \rightarrow \cos \phi - i \sin \phi$

$= \frac{I + \hat{r} \cdot \vec{\sigma}}{2}$

$| \pm \rangle = | \pm x \rangle = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} (| 0 \rangle \pm | 1 \rangle)$
 $| \pm y \rangle = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} (| 0 \rangle \pm i | 1 \rangle)$



Bloch vector: $\hat{r} = (\sin \theta \cos \phi, \sin \theta \sin \phi, \cos \theta) = (x, y, z)$, $|\hat{r}| = 1$

Pauli vector operator: $\vec{\sigma} = (X, Y, Z)$

$I = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$, $X = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}$, $Y = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & -i \\ i & 0 \end{pmatrix}$, $Z = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & -1 \end{pmatrix}$

$x | \pm x \rangle = \pm 1 | \pm x \rangle$

$y | \pm y \rangle = \pm 1 | \pm y \rangle$

$z | 0 \rangle = +1 | 0 \rangle$

$z | 1 \rangle = -1 | 1 \rangle$

